

Tutor Handbook

Practical guide for use alongside the formal JTA documents, SKOOL, NotebookLM, and the portal.

This handbook is a practical route through the JTA system. The formal JF, JTS, and JTD documents remain the source of truth.

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How to use the JTA learning system

Channel	Role
Formal documents	Source of truth
Handbook	Practical route
SKOOL	Paced pathway
NotebookLM	Clarification and recap
Portal	Access hub

Use this handbook for day-to-day action. Use the formal documents when you need the exact standard, threshold, or rule.

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Chapter 1 — Welcome to JTA

Purpose: Orient you to the academy quickly, show how the learning system fits together, and reduce early uncertainty.

The Jothi Tutor Academy is a structured development system for academic tutors. It is not a passive course and not a collection of isolated resources. The academy is designed to help you improve through live teaching, focused reflection, mentor feedback, and evidence-based progression.

This handbook is your practical guide. It should help you know what good looks like, what to do next, and how to use the wider JTA system without feeling pulled in four directions at once.

Resource	Use it for	Do not use it for
This handbook	Day-to-day guidance and practical interpretation	Replacing the formal standards
Formal JF/JTS/JTD documents	Exact standards, thresholds, and decision rules	Quick first guidance before every lesson
SKOOL	Ordered learning path and weekly sequence	Holding the whole system in your head
NotebookLM	Clarification, recap, and fast explanation	Creating new rules or new standards
Portal	Finding the official files and links	Replacing the handbook or SKOOL

Your progress in JTA is based on demonstrated teaching quality. Time helps, but time does not certify you. The academy moves tutors forward when the evidence shows they are ready.

You are expected to approach the residency actively. That means preparing carefully, using feedback well, reflecting honestly, and improving one clear teaching move at a time.

What this means in practice

Start with this handbook and SKOOL. Use the formal documents when you need the exact wording of a standard. Ask your mentor when the issue is lesson-specific, stage-specific, or evidence-specific.

Chapter 2 — How the Residency Works

Purpose: Give you one clear mental map of the residency pathway so you can focus on the next stage without losing sight of the whole system.

The residency is a pathway with increasing teaching responsibility. You do not move forward because a certain number of weeks have passed. You move forward when the evidence shows you can handle the next level of responsibility at the required standard.

Stage	What you do	What mentors are looking for
Observation	Watch live teaching through the 4T lens and reflect on what you notice.	Active noticing of teaching moves, not passive note-taking on topic coverage.
Co-Teaching	Lead short planned sections with mentor support present throughout.	Early JCT1 evidence, especially clarity, questioning, checking, reliability, and coachability.
Lead Teaching	Hold progressively longer lessons with mentor observation.	JCT1 consistency and early JCT2 emergence across multiple lessons.
Independent Teaching	Run a full teaching cycle with continued oversight and evidence gathering.	Consistent quality across time, assessment use, and stronger JCT2/JCT3 evidence.
Certification Runway	Close any remaining evidence gaps before panel review.	Specific final evidence, not repetition for its own sake.

The mentor helps you plan, observe, reflect, and improve. The mentor panel reviews evidence at key points in the pathway so progression decisions are not based on one person's impression alone.

Certification is not a reward for staying in the system long enough. It is a formal decision that you are ready to teach independently at the Jothi standard with sufficient consistency and professional reliability.

Stage progress and competency progress are related, but they are not identical. A tutor can reach Lead Teaching and still need more evidence in a particular JCT1 area. That must be addressed directly rather than assumed away.

What this means in practice

Focus on the job of your current stage. Treat each observation, reflection, and mentor conversation as part of the evidence base that will either support progression or show what still needs to improve.

Chapter 3 — The Jothi Model of Learning

Purpose: Explain the learning model that sits underneath JTA so you can see lessons as more than

content delivery.

The Jothi model begins with three conditions that must work together for durable learning to happen: Strategy, Mindset, and Environment. JTA calls this the Jothi Trifecta.

Dimension	What it means	What it looks like in a lesson
Strategy	The lesson is deliberately designed: concepts are sequenced, explanations are clear, and understanding is checked before the tutor moves on.	You know the lesson focus, likely difficulty, and how you will check the student's reasoning.
Mindset	The tutor shapes how students respond to challenge, effort, and error.	You treat mistakes as information, not failure, and help students persist through difficulty.
Environment	The conditions for serious learning are protected.	You maintain a focused technical setup, a calm tone, clear expectations, and a safe space for students to admit confusion.

Within this model, you are not only a content deliverer. You operate simultaneously as a Strategist, a Coach, and a Facilitator. Subject knowledge supports the Strategist role, but the residency develops the other two roles with equal seriousness.

When tutors struggle, the issue is often not intelligence or goodwill. More often, the issue is that one of the three conditions is weak. The practical question is not 'Did I cover the content?' but 'Did I create the conditions in which learning could actually happen?'

What this means in practice

When a lesson goes badly, diagnose it through the Trifecta. Ask: was the plan weak, was the student's response to challenge poorly handled, or did the environment make focused learning difficult?

Chapter 4 — The 4T Teaching Engine

Purpose: Make the 4T lesson model usable in real teaching rather than abstract or theoretical.

The 4T Teaching Engine is the lesson spine used in JTA. It turns the Trifecta into observable teaching behaviour. Strong Jothi lessons do not rely on explanation alone. They move through Teach, Test, Track, and Transform repeatedly as understanding develops.

Phase	What you do	Strong practice	Weak practice
Teach	Introduce the idea step by step with visible reasoning.	The student can follow how each step connects to the previous one.	You show final answers or skip the reasoning that produced

Phase	What you do	Strong practice	Weak practice
			them.
Test	Ask questions that reveal how the student is thinking.	The student must explain, justify, predict, or compare.	You accept 'yes' or a correct answer as proof of understanding.
Track	Observe the student's working, hesitation, and error patterns.	You can see where understanding breaks down and what that breakdown means.	You watch final answers only and miss the route taken.
Transform	Correct the source of misunderstanding and rebuild the reasoning.	The student understands why the correction is correct and can re-apply it.	You give the answer, the student copies it, and the misconception stays alive.

4T is a cycle, not a checklist. A lesson may go through a quick cycle in two minutes or a full cycle over twenty minutes. What matters is that you do not collapse into one-way explanation and assume learning has happened because the room stayed quiet.

The 4T model is also the main observation lens mentors use. If you understand 4T well, you will understand far more clearly what your mentor is looking for and why.

What this means in practice

Do not ask yourself only, 'Did I explain it?' Ask instead: 'How did I test the understanding, what did I notice, and how did I respond when the thinking was wrong?'

Chapter 5 — What Strong Jothi Teaching Looks Like

Purpose: Translate the 4T cycle into practical lesson habits you can see, hear, and improve.

Strong Jothi teaching is not a polished performance. It is clear, diagnostic, responsive, and student-active. The following features are what mentors and students should consistently experience in your lessons.

Clear explanation

Explanations are broken into followable steps. The student does not have to infer missing reasoning. Board work supports the explanation rather than replacing it.

Visible reasoning

The student can see how the answer is built. The board shows process, not only result. This is why live writing matters so much in JTA teaching.

Diagnostic questioning

Questions are used to reveal what the student is thinking. The tutor uses the answer to decide what to do next rather than moving forward automatically.

Active checking

A correct answer is not accepted without checking whether the reasoning behind it is secure.

Guided practice

The student does the thinking. The tutor supports with prompts, questions, and selective intervention rather than taking over the work.

Misconception correction

The tutor identifies the source of error and rebuilds the reasoning clearly. A simple correction of the answer is not enough.

Movement toward independence

As understanding grows, the student carries more of the cognitive load. The lesson does not leave the student permanently dependent on tutor prompting.

School context awareness

Lesson content is informed by what the student's school is currently teaching, what assessments are approaching, and what support is most relevant now.

What this means in practice

Students should be thinking, writing, or explaining for most of the lesson. Correct answers matter, but correct reasoning matters more.

Chapter 6 — The Competency Framework

Purpose: Help you understand the competency system without making the handbook compete with the formal framework.

The competency framework gives JTA a shared language for observation, coaching, sign-off, and certification. It does not exist to create bureaucracy. It exists so that mentors and tutors can talk about teaching quality precisely.

JTA uses 22 competencies grouped across six domains. Each competency also belongs to a development level: JCT1, JCT2, or JCT3. The formal framework remains the source of truth. This handbook gives you a practical reading of how to use it.

Domain	Focus	Examples of what it covers
A — Subject Knowledge	Making subject knowledge teachable	Conceptual understanding, student error diagnosis, expert problem-solving
B — Lesson Design	Structuring learning deliberately	Purpose, sequencing, multiple representations
C — Live Teaching	What happens inside the	Clarity, questioning, checking, guided practice,

Domain	Focus	Examples of what it covers
	lesson	feedback
D — Assessment	Using evidence from performance	Diagnosis, progress tracking, intervention planning, exam readiness
E — Student Development	Mindset and learning habits	Effort, persistence, revision habits, self-monitoring
F — Professional Practice	Operating professionally	Parent communication, reliability, feedback engagement, ethics

Level	In plain language	Typical stage relevance
JCT1	Foundational behaviours that should be visible early and become consistent by the end of Lead Teaching.	Observation, Co-Teaching, Lead Teaching
JCT2	Stronger instructional judgement and wider professional contribution.	Lead Teaching, Independent Teaching
JCT3	Higher-level quality shown across time, not just inside one lesson.	Independent Teaching, Certification Runway

- Sign-off is not a reward for effort. It is recognition that a specific competency has been shown with repeated, credible evidence.
- Self-report can support the development picture, but it does not replace mentor-observed evidence.
- You do not need to focus on all 22 competencies at once. Focus on the stage-appropriate area your mentor is working on with you now.

What this means in practice

Learn the language of the competencies, but do not try to carry the whole framework into every lesson. Carry the one or two priorities that matter now.

Chapter 7 — Stage-by-Stage Expectations

Purpose: Tell you what your job is at each stage so you can direct your effort accurately.

Observation

Your job is to read the lesson, not just watch it. Notice the teaching moves, the questions, the hesitation points, and the corrections. Complete the reflection form on the same day and bring specific observations to the debrief.

Mentor will look for: What mentors want to see: active noticing, accurate 4T language, and honest reflection.

Co-Teaching

Your job is to plan and teach short sections with your mentor present. Keep the scope narrow and deliberate. Focus on core JCT1 behaviours: clarity, diagnostic questioning, checking, reliability, and coachability.

Mentor will look for: What mentors want to see: you can hold a short section, remain composed, and act on feedback next time.

Lead Teaching

Your job is to hold longer lessons with increasing consistency. By the end of this stage JCT1 should feel consistent, not occasional. JCT2 begins to appear through stronger planning, sequencing, guided practice, and feedback.

Mentor will look for: What mentors want to see: quality sustained across 30, 45, and 60-minute sessions, not one strong peak.

Independent Teaching

Your job is to hold a teaching cycle, not just a single lesson. You are expected to teach across time, use assessment properly, identify what progress data means, and support clear progress communication under oversight.

Mentor will look for: What mentors want to see: stable quality across six lessons, not isolated strong moments.

The Certification Runway is not another teaching stage. It is a focused evidence phase in which the remaining gaps are closed and the final readiness pack is prepared.

What this means in practice

Every stage has a different job. Do not try to perform a later stage before you can carry the current one properly.

Chapter 8 — Reflection and Improvement

Purpose: Make reflection useful rather than administrative and show how tutor improvement actually compounds across the residency.

The development loop in JTA is simple: Plan, Teach, Reflect, Improve. Reflection is not the end of that loop. The loop closes only when the next-step target from one lesson is carried into the next one and acted on in live teaching.

Weak reflection	Stronger reflection
Summarises the topic and says the lesson went well.	Names a specific teaching moment and explains what it revealed about the student's understanding.
Rates everything highly with no evidence.	Rates honestly and uses a clear example to justify the

Weak reflection	Stronger reflection
	judgement.
Lists five things to improve.	Identifies one main next-step target.
Completes the form the next day from memory.	Completes the form the same day while the details are still clear.

Weak target	Strong target
Improve my questioning.	After each worked example, ask the student to predict what changes if one value changes.
Be more structured.	Write the lesson steps on the board before the explanation starts and signpost each transition.
Check understanding better.	Before moving into practice, ask the student to explain the method back without looking at the board.

Use mentor feedback productively. That means hearing it without defensiveness, carrying it forward, and being able to show in the next lesson where you tried to act on it.

If you believe a mentor assessment is incorrect or feedback is unfair, raise it directly with academy leadership through the approved Jothi channel rather than handling it informally.

What this means in practice

Reflection is valuable when it creates a usable next move. If your target cannot be attempted in the very next lesson, it is still too vague.

Chapter 9 — Assessment, Progress, and Communication

Purpose: Show how lesson delivery connects to progress decisions, progress tracking, and communication with families.

Assessment at Jothi is part of teaching rather than a separate event. You are not collecting marks for their own sake. You are collecting evidence about what the student understands, what is fragile, and what still needs to be rebuilt.

If assessment shows...	Teaching response
Secure understanding across the topic	Move forward and introduce the right level of challenge.

If assessment shows...	Teaching response
Correct answers but weak explanation	Do not progress yet. Slow down and test the reasoning behind the answer.
Patterned error or repeated misconception	Stop, reteach the underlying concept, and rebuild before layering more complexity.
Forgotten content from earlier lessons	Build retrieval and spaced revisit into the next lessons.
Weak performance across the whole topic	Review whether the explanation, sequence, or pace was the problem and reteach with a better approach.

Progress over time is not the accumulation of completed topics. It is the growth of reliable, transferable understanding. This is why JTA values cumulative evidence, not just one good result immediately after teaching.

Parent communication must be clear, evidence-based, and professional. Tutors should explain what the student now understands well, what remains insecure, what the next teaching focus is, and what support would help between sessions.

Under-18 tutors must not communicate directly with parents. Where parent communication is part of the learning system, this must be handled by an adult mentor or academy leadership.

What this means in practice

Marks are not enough. Always ask what the performance tells you about the student's reasoning and what you now need to do differently.

Chapter 10 — Tools and Practical Routines

Purpose: Reduce avoidable friction in online teaching and make strong preparation feel normal.

In JTA, technical setup is not separate from teaching quality. A weak setup breaks explanation, monitoring, and correction. Good preparation protects the learning conditions before the lesson begins.

Before the lesson

- Check your internet, audio, Zoom login, and room assignment before the student is waiting.
- Open the digital board and have the relevant page ready.
- Prepare the Classkick assignment or live task in advance.
- Check Ayotree, the student details, and the school context you need for the lesson.

During the lesson

- Keep the board visible and legible.

- Use Classkick or another approved live-visibility method where appropriate.
- Reduce unnecessary tab-switching and avoid searching for files mid-lesson.
- Watch the student's working, not just the final answer.

After the lesson

- Mark attendance in Ayotree promptly.
- Complete any daily report accurately.
- Write your reflection the same day.
- Carry the next-step target into your next plan.

Tool	Its role in the system
Zoom	Live teaching, recordings, room structure, and screen-sharing.
Digital board	Visible reasoning and step-by-step explanation.
Classkick	Live visibility of student working, especially in group teaching.
Ayotree	Schedule, attendance, and operational record.
Portal	Access to official documents and links.
NotebookLM	Fast clarification and recap when you need it.

What this means in practice

Preparation is part of teaching. Setting up while the student waits is not a small issue; it is a preventable quality failure.

Chapter 11 — Professional Conduct and Safeguarding

Purpose: State the baseline professional standard clearly so tutors know the minimum expectation from day one.

Pillar	What it requires
Prepare	Be on time, set up, and ready to begin with the right materials and the right student context.
Behave	Stay composed, respectful, and learning-focused in all interactions.
Communicate	Use clear language and approved channels only.

Pillar	What it requires
Protect	Handle student information carefully, maintain boundaries, and escalate concerns through the correct process.

Professional conduct does not begin after certification. It begins from your first observed lesson. Reliability, ethical judgement, and proper escalation are part of the core standard, not extra features.

If you are under 18, the development pathway remains open to you, but the boundary rules are tighter. Parent contact must be handled by an adult mentor or leadership, and you should never be left to manage concerns alone.

The safest and simplest rule is this: if you are unsure, escalate. Do not improvise a response to safeguarding, welfare, GDPR, or conduct issues on your own.

What this means in practice

Warmth and professionalism are not opposites. In JTA, warmth is expressed through preparation, clarity, reliability, and respect for the student's learning.

Chapter 12 — Common Tutor Mistakes to Avoid

Purpose: Prevent predictable teaching problems before they become habits that slow down your development.

Mistake	Why it matters	What to do instead
Rushing to cover content	Coverage without understanding creates fragile learning.	Slow down and secure the concept before extending it.
Treating correct answers as enough	Students can be procedurally right and conceptually weak.	Check the reasoning behind the answer before moving on.
Teaching without visible reasoning	Students see the answer but not how to reach it.	Build the thinking live on the board.
Using only surface-level checks	You miss the real state of understanding.	Ask questions that require explanation or prediction.
Treating reflection as admin	The improvement loop breaks.	Use reflection to generate one real next-step target.
Becoming defensive with feedback	You lose the fastest route to improvement.	Act on one target and show where you tried it next time.

Mistake	Why it matters	What to do instead
Ignoring school context	The lesson may be strong but off-topic and poorly timed.	Ask what school is covering and when assessments are due.

What this means in practice

Most weak teaching patterns are visible early. Strong tutors are not the ones who never struggle; they are the ones who correct early and improve deliberately.

Chapter 13 — Where to Go Next

Purpose: Close the handbook by reinforcing the non-competing access model and showing you how to get help efficiently.

This handbook is your practical guide for day-to-day teaching and development. It does not replace the formal JTA standards. As you move into greater teaching responsibility, keep using the wider system in the right way.

After certification, independent teaching does not mean development has ended. It means you are trusted to hold teaching responsibility at the required Jothi standard. That standard still applies. Periodic review, feedback, and continued professional development remain part of the academy's quality system.

Use SKOOL when you need the next step in sequence. Use the portal when you need the formal source documents. Use NotebookLM when you need a plain-language recap, a quick clarification, or help locating the right document. Use this handbook when you need practical guidance on what to do in real teaching and mentoring situations.

If something is unclear, raise it through the correct route. Start with your mentor for normal teaching, reflection, and stage-related questions. If the issue is about fairness, disagreement with an assessment, or something that should not be handled only within the mentor relationship, raise it directly with academy leadership through the approved Jothi channel.

All routes lead to the same standard. Use the route that helps you act clearly, not the one that gives you the most pages.